

THE
COMMUNICATIONS
AND ELECTRONICS BRANCH

95 CRAFTSMAN BOULEVARD
CFB KINGSTON, ONTARIO, K7K 7B4



BRANCHE
DES COMMUNICATIONS
ET DE L'ÉLECTRONIQUE

95 CRAFTSMAN BOULEVARD
BFC KINGSTON, ONTARIO, K7K 7B4

1000-5 (Br Adjt)

20 June 2022

Distribution List

BRANCH ADVISORY COUNCIL
RECORD OF DECISIONS – MONDAY, 20 MAY 2022

RECORD OF ATTENDANCE

POSITION / APPOINTMENT	RANK & NAME
Chair / Colonel Commandant	Brigadier-General Josée Robidoux (Retired)
Co-Chair / Branch Leader	Brigadier-General James Lambert
Member / Previous Colonel Commandant	Brigadier-General Kevin O'Keefe (Retired)
Member / Branch Advisor	Colonel John Roper
Member / Branch Chief	Chief Warrant Officer Gilles Philibert (REGRETS)
Member / Association President	Major-General John Leech (Retired)
Member / Foundation President	Mr. Scott Mclean (REGRETS)
Member / Serving General Officer	Brigadier-General Patrice Sabourin (REGRETS)
Member / Serving General Officer	Brigadier-General Pascal Godbout
Member / Serving General Officer	Colonel David Yarker (to be promoted Brigadier-General)
Member / Honorary Rep	Colonel Ken Lloyd
Guest / Museum Rep	Major Geoff Priems
Guest / Incoming Branch Adjutant	Major Gavin Ellis
Guest / Incoming Branch Chief	Chief Warrant Officer Alex Arndt
Secretariat / Branch Adjutant	Major Blair Christie

OPENING REMARKS

- **Brigadier-General Lambert:**

Retiring in several weeks. Conveyed the importance of convening the Senate before the APS.

- **Colonel Commandant:**

Welcomed the incoming Branch Chief: CWO Alex Arndt.

REVIEW & APPROVAL OF PRIOR ROD

- **Colonel Commandant:**

Approved with the following items to be brought forth at the next Senate meeting:

- Honour Roll – bring forward (Foundation speaking point)
- Criteria for Entry onto Honour Roll – bring forward (Foundation speaking point)
- Nominations for 3 x HCol CFIOG (unknown ATT as confirmed by BGen Lambert. DGIMO receives courtesy information once approved and will advise Col Cmdt)

- **Colonel Roper:**

Several initiatives underway ...

- Focus on updating RCEME MoU (meeting to follow);
- Efforts on governance (with discussion held between Priems, Martineau, and O'Keefe);
- Financial aspects need to be firmly understood: e.g. NPP and Base Comd authorities; and
- Review / update / sign off SOPs to grant them legitimacy (aim is the Fall / Autumn).

Aim is two-fold: have a report to the Senate after the Summer Break reference the MoU, governance, and financial clarity; and have the SOPs updated and signed in the Autumn DTG.

ACTION ITEM(s):

- **Foundation:**

Bring forward the Honour Roll and Criteria for Honour Roll entry plan.

- **Colonel Roper:**

Museum governance report owed to the Senate for situational awareness (ETA Summer 2022), and updated Museum SOP submissions complete with official signatures to be released thereafter (autumn 2022).

OLD BUSINESS I – BATTLEFIELD STUDY TOUR 2023

▪ **Colonel Roper:**

Meeting held with Hugh Janssen; tour preparations are proceeding well. Command Team is confirmed. Membership sits at 61 x members on tour with room for +1 without impacting cost. Any more than 62 will require a financial re-visit / re-calculation. RCAF now has 6 x members. Event Request (ER) submitted to DIMCBM. Funding model ...

- Sponsoring unit = \$2,500.00
- Member's contribution = \$250.00
- Branch = \$1,500.00
- TOTAL = \$4,500.00 per soldier / aviator

ACTION ITEM(s):

▪ **Branch Office:**

Keep *heat & light* on the ER submission.

OLD BUSINESS II – HRH VISIT

▪ **Colonel Commandant:**

Not much has changed or significantly progressed since last update. The planned visit is on HRH calendar. The 8th Canadian Hussars (8 CH) = OPI and will confirm HRH interest by this Fall. Proposal is a Signals contingent (x 50) on parade + 1 hour private audience + gala attendance.

OLD BUSINESS III – C&E FAMILY SURVEY

▪ **Colonel Commandant:**

Only 168 personnel took the last survey. The Col Cmdt intends to do something about this and will put time & interest into a plan. She required a team help). The aim is to come back to the Senate and outline a plan / proposal to tackle Branch ID & morale issues. Some initial direction & guidance (D&G) includes a change to branding and modifying information passage / the communication strategy, etc. Make governance of the Branch more visible / transparent.

- **Brigadier-General (Ret'd) O'Keefe:**

The previous Col Cmdt worked on the initial survey. 20 x RFI / questions were created to specifically target Branch issues (Branch, Museum, Foundation, Association concerns) via *Survey Monkey*. The issue entailed a \$1,200.00 translation requirement which could not be surpassed. To mitigate, the Q&A survey was *bolted* onto a Museum survey. The Museum had grant money to conduct its own study for Museum purposes and they absorbed the Branch questionnaire. Some RFI were re-phrased, removed, and / or jumbled up with the Museum. This caused a loss in intent & translation as the survey appeared misguided and unfocused.

- **Brigadier-General Godbout:**

Museum survey came to him via personal e-mail as he is registered with the Foundation. Verify who is receiving this information and make efforts to broaden the net and leverage existing media platforms.

- **Major General (Ret'd) Leech:**

Wishes to volunteer to help with the Col Cmdt's survey plan.

- **CWO Arndt:**

Wishes to volunteer to help with Col Cmdt's survey plan.

ACTION ITEM(s):

- **Incoming Branch Adjutant:**

Work with Tech Warrant and create / upload a RoD & Governance sub-site on CMCEN for increased transparency. All SOPs, governance documents, and RoDs for the Senate and BAC are on the *Mercury Drive*.

- **Brigadier-General (Ret'd) O'Keefe:**

Forward original Q&A survey to General Robidoux

- **Colonel Commandant:**

Capture original Q&A battery, absorb Majeo-General (Ret) Leech and CWO Arndt into the team, and prepare – as planned – a Q&A survey for the Senate in hopes to confirm morale, branding, and interest / involvement issues facing the community.

NEW BUSINESS I – NEW BRANCH LEADER

- **Brigadier-General Lambert:**

Brigadier-General Yarker – upon promotion – shall be appointed the new Branch Leader. He was previously the Branch Advisor and thus is highly aware of Branch affairs, business, and issues.

ACTION ITEM(s):

- **Incoming & Outgoing Branch Adjutants:**

Work with the Colonel Commandant to draft official correspondence to HRH so as to notify her of the change-of-appointment. In previous years, HRH requested a virtual meeting with the incoming and outgoing Branch Leaders.

- **Incoming & Outgoing Branch Chiefs:**

Confirm change-of-appointment ceremony for the Branch Chief position. Note that a large wooden caduceus – safeguarded in the Branch Adjutant's Office – is wall-mounted and used for such occasions. The wooden plaque / base that it hangs from contains the engraved names of all previous Branch Chiefs.

- **Incoming Branch Adjutant:**

The new Branch Leader, Branch Adjutant, and Branch Chief must be reflect in ...

- The Branch Standing Orders (BSO): Copies on the Mercury Drive, CMCEN, and SP
- The Branch Adjutant's Plaque (Branch Adjutant's Office)
- The Branch Chief's Caduceus Mount (Branch Adjutant's Office)
- CMCEN Leadership Page
- Branch Adjutant's SP Leadership sub-site

NEW BUSINESS II – C&E WEEK 2022

- **Colonel Roper:**

Standard C&E Week events are already programmed in ... Carruthers Gravesite Ceremony, Exercise NOBLE SKYWAVE (Ex NS), Subalterns' & Sergeants' Indoctrination, 2 x Mess Dinners, and the C&E Family Update (paired with the Branch H&A ceremony). All COs in Kingston have OPIs / Command Teams for major current events. C&E Week 2022 shall remain a hybrid delivery option (in-person + MS Teams or other virtual means). Key Notes speakers are needed to discuss relevant briefings (e.g. impart more relevant and interactive briefs on Cyber, AI, deployments, etc.) and not standard *boiler-plate* PD lectures. Competitions are TBC / TBD. Event Request (ER) already submitted as ordered. Need to de-conflict with Int, and need to staff a baseline agenda to CFSCE to help with bookings / venues, etc.

ACTION ITEM(s):

- **Incoming Branch Adjutant:**

Confirm the PTA and STA (Primary & Secondary Training Audience) for each C&E Week 2022 event and place these details in the C&E Week Instruction.

NEW BUSINESS III – BRANCH REPORT

- **Colonel Roper:**

Points as follows ...

- Annual Branch Battle Rhythm (Golf / Curling) needs to be re-evaluated as the activities to see if they still resonate with new members. This could be an entry-point into the Branch Survey headed by the Colonel Commandant;
- Branch Commendation: Hugh Janssen wishes to be presented his award after the Battlefield Tour; and
- Major Gavin Ellis welcomed as the incoming Branch Adjutant. Major Ellis assumes the post in mid-July 2022.

NEW BUSINESS IV – MUSEUM REPORT

- **Major Priems:**
As per enclosed presentation.

NEW BUSINESS V – FOUNDATION REPORT

- **Mr. Scott McLean:**
Not present for Senate Meeting.

NEW BUSINESS VI – ASSOCIATION REPORT

- **Major-General (Ret'd) Leech:**
As per slide ...
 - Conference of Defence Associations:
 - NCR in March – widely attended (proved effectiveness of hybrid attendance) with interesting assortment of panels and speakers. Nickola Goddard Award was bestowed to a member of 34 Signal Regiment;
 - AGM in May – Legion involvement plus VCDS panel with 3 x service DComds with emphasis on digitization.
 - Participation in museum committee work – Association involvement is important and well-received by members. Continue to review the amount of work done on governance structure;
 - PD in C&E Week – Association wants to proceed again for 2022 (hybrid approach) and they need a lot of volunteer power. Need sponsorships, people, and interest; and
 - Quarterly Newsletter – Association has a communications effort aimed at retirees and veterans outreach. 1st newsletter was sent out about a month ago to a roster of contacts contained by the association. Association serves as a link to existing orgs (like a hub). The letter confirmed – for example – that we have a Senate and a Colonel Commandant.
- Another newsletter is planned for the summer (including news of the NL Tour).

- Veterans – 80th anniversary of Dieppe Raid (the Association asked permission to send RCCS member as a representative but could not get one due to limitations). Burlington resident is RCCS veteran of Dieppe.
- Colonel Don Pruner – C&E Branch architect – passed away in November.

ACTION ITEM(s):

- **ALCON:**
Ask other members of the Senate who this newsletter should go out to
- **Major-General (Ret'd) Leech:**
Brigadier General(Ret) O'Keefe requested a copy and permission to be added to the Newsletter Distr List.

CLOSING REMARKS

- **ALCON**
NSTR – Nothing Significant To Report.

ACTION ITEM(s):

- **Incoming Branch Adjutant:**
Keep the Colonel Commandant well-informed of Last Posts, including a précis of service history and requirements to attend funeral processions (including the wearing of a mourning band).
- **Colonel Commandant and Incoming Branch Adjutant:**
Keep the ROSEN Mess Dinner (1st Friday of June each year) remains in the plans for next year. D&G found in the Branch Standing Orders (BSO).

ROBIDOUX, JOSEE 589

Digitally signed by ROBIDOUX, JOSEE
589
Date: 2022.06.27 11:30:27 -04'00'

Brigadier-General Josée Robidoux, OMM, CD (Retired)
Branch Leader



Brigadier-General James Lambert, CD
Branch Leader

C&E BRANCH SENATE MEETING



Monday, 20 1500 June 2022

AGENDA:

- ▶ Opening Remarks (**Branch Leadership**)
- ▶ Review and Approval of Previous Minutes (**Colonel Commandant**)
- ▶ Old Business I - Netherlands 2023 Update (**Branch Advisor**)
- ▶ Old Business II - HRH Visit 2023 Update (**Colonel Commandant**)
- ▶ Old Business III - C&E Family Survey: Next Steps (**Colonel Commandant**)
- ▶ New Business I - New Branch Leader (**Branch Leader**)
- ▶ New Business II - C&E Week 2022: 24-28 Oct 22 (**Branch Advisor**)
- ▶ New Business III - Branch Report (**Branch Advisor & Branch Adjutant**)
- ▶ New Business IV - Museum Report (**Officer Commanding Museum**)
- ▶ New Business V - Foundation Report (**Foundation President**)
- ▶ New Business VI - Association Report (**Association President**)
- ▶ Closing Remarks (**ALCON**)

C&E MUSEUM:

1. General
2. Brief Financial Update
3. Museum Posture
4. Covid Rules Posture



General

- ▶ OC Museum - Maj Priems - arrived 17 Jan.
 - ▶ 2 x Museum Committee Meetings
 - ▶ 1 x Board of Directors Meeting
 - ▶ 1 x Volunteer Welcome Back Event
- ▶ Policy Approvals
 - ▶ Admissions Policy and Procedure Approval
 - ▶ Volunteer Policy
 - ▶ Adopt a Display Policy (single/multiyear; and special program)
- ▶ Website Launch: www.candemuseum.org



Brief Financial info

- ▶ Support in 21/22
 - ▶ Foundation, \$140K
 - ▶ CFB Kingston, \$100k direct, about \$650k in support
 - ▶ CFSCE, approx. \$150k in support (PATs)
 - ▶ Mercury Shop (separate business) -break even
 - ▶ RCEME - \$35.5k
 - ▶ CFMWS - over \$100k (salary support)
 - ▶ Grants
 - ▶ Eastern Ontario Tourism (RTO9) \$10k; \$5k
 - ▶ Museum Development fund (MDF): \$55k
- ▶ Budget
 - ▶ FY 20-21 - \$6k deficit (approx. 50% of wages subsidized from CFMWS)
 - ▶ FY 21-22 - balanced (approx. 70% of wages subsidized from CFMWS)
 - ▶ FY 22-23 - projecting modest gain



Museum Posture:

March 2020 - Shut doors to all
June 2020 - 1 or 2 staff only to facilitate remote changes of command
Sept 2020 - full strength, online shopping only
Dec 2020 - 1 staff member per day only
Sept 2021 - full strength, Shop and Museum fully open
Nov 2021 - 35% staff, Museum closed, Shop open
Jan 2022 - 1 staff member per day only, Fully Closed - online only
Feb 2022 - 35% staff, Online only
March 2022 - full staff, open

Current Status:

Masks are worn by everyone visiting/working in the Museum, Mercury Shop or Conference Room.
Physical distancing recommended
Small Conference Room designated for Lunches
Conference Room - for DND/CF use only at present. Max grouping is 25.
Hours: 10am-3:30pm (May long weekend to Sept long weekend - open 7 days a week).

Gallery Changes:

Some items have had the plastic coverings removed (but not all)
Barriers will remain in place for the foreseeable future until posture change by CMA/CCI/OMA
Some exhibits have been made inaccessible due to COVID safety requirements

COVID Posture

- ▶ Subject to Orders, Instructions, etc from:
 - ▶ Directorate of History and Heritage - Federal Government
 - ▶ Organization of Military Museums of Canada (OMMC)
 - ▶ Canada Conservation Institute (CCI)
 - ▶ Canada Museum Association (CMA)
 - ▶ Ontario Museum Association (OMA) - best practices
 - ▶ Base Comd, CFB Kingston - Federal Government
 - ▶ Province of Ontario
 - ▶ Medical Officer of Health for KLF&A
- ▶ Posture varies wildly between Bases and Provinces

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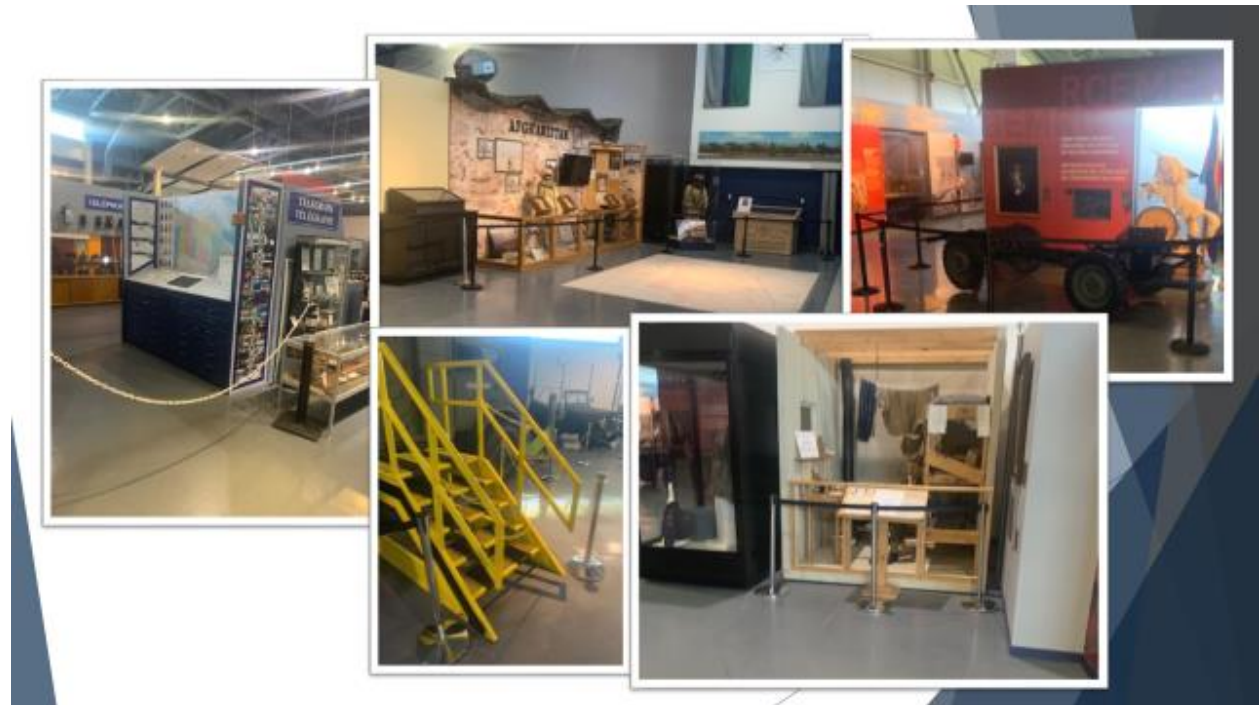
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Current COVID Posture





C&E ASSOCIATION:

- ▶ CONFERENCE OF DEFENCE ASSOCIATIONS
- ▶ PARTICIPATION IN MUSEUM COMMITTEE WORK
- ▶ PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT FOR C&E WEEK
- ▶ QUARTERLY NEWSLETTER